

Terbium

65
Tb

Pure terbium is soft enough to cut with a knife. Some of its compounds are used to line mercury lamps. When electrified, mercury vapour inside these lamps gives out ultraviolet light, which turns bright yellow due to terbium.

ATOMIC MASS 158.925

STATE Solid

DISCOVERY 1843 (Carl Gustav Mosander)

In the 19th century, scientists got confused between terbium and erbium and accidentally switched their names.

**Laboratory sample
of pure terbium**

